

Candidate commitment

Not a law. Not a by-law. Signing it does not put anyone in office.

29 September 2026

In plain words

- You read the codes before you run.
- You sign this and give members a copy before election day.
- If you win and don't do what it says, you agree to resign.
- It's voluntary. Nobody can force a candidate to sign. Members can see who did.

Why this draft is here

The codes do nothing until members adopt them. A candidate who will follow them can say so in writing before the vote, and can agree to step down if they don't follow through.

1. What this is

- 1.1 This is a personal commitment made by a person running for chief or councillor. It is not a law, not a by-law, and not a band council resolution.
- 1.2 Signing it does not put anyone in office and does not change who may run. The election rule in force decides that.
- 1.3 Signing is voluntary. A candidate who does not sign can still run. Members decide what signing, or not signing, means to them.

2. What the candidate does

- 2.1 If you are running, do these steps yourself:
 - Download this commitment.
 - Read it, and read the codes it names.
 - Sign it and date it in front of a witness.
 - Post it where members can see it.
 - Give a signed copy to any member who asks.
 - If you want, record a short video saying you signed it and you mean it.
- 2.2 Do this before election day. A commitment signed after the vote does not count as a pre-election commitment.

3. The commitment

- 3.1 I have read the constitution, the bill of rights, the election code, the council procedure, the conduct and conflict of interest code, the band money code, and the spending and contracts code in this set.

- 3.2 If I take office, I will put those codes to a member vote within 90 days. I will not ask council to adopt them by resolution alone, because a code council adopts alone can be undone by council alone.
- 3.3 Until members vote on those codes, I will follow them myself as if they were in force.
- 3.4 I will not vote on my own pay, honorarium, travel, or a contract with me or my immediate family. I will leave the room.
- 3.5 I will not commit more than \$10,000 of the First Nation's money by myself. I will not sign a contract over \$25,000 unless a public call for bids was posted for 14 days.
- 3.6 I will support posting the audited financial statements and the remuneration schedule within 120 days after year end, and a plain quarterly statement within 30 days after each quarter.
- 3.7 I will support posting council minutes within 7 days of each meeting.
- 3.8 I will not vote to postpone the fixed election day.
- 3.9 I will file a written conflict disclosure within 5 days of taking office, and within 5 days of any new conflict.
- 3.10 Within 30 days of taking office I will post 3 to 5 goals, each with a number, a date, or a clear result. Within 30 days after each quarter I will post a report on them.
- 3.11 I will not vote to cancel, delay, or defund a member vote or a removal petition that meets the rules.
- 3.12 If I take office and do not follow this commitment, I agree to resign. I will hand over records, keys, devices, and passwords within 7 days of resigning.

4. Signing

- 4.1 Candidate for (office): _____
- 4.2 Signature: _____ Date: _____

4.3 Witness signature: _____ Date: _____

Check before relying on it

a resignation promise is a personal promise. If a person refuses to resign, the removal rule in the election code in force is still the path. A lawyer should look at that rule before anyone relies on the resignation line in a dispute.